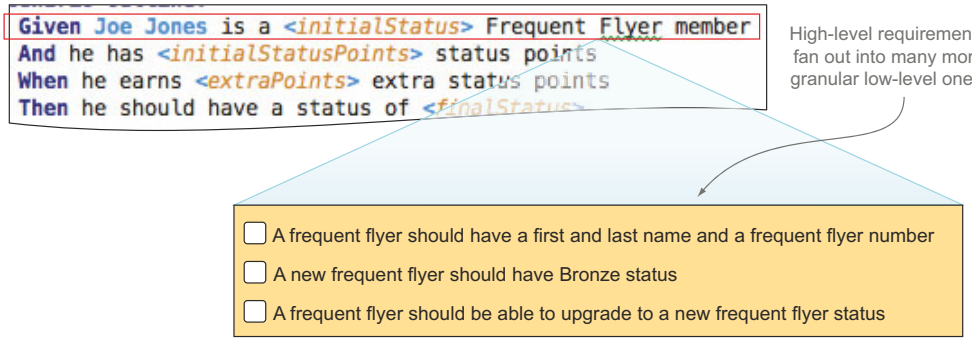


Figure 10.5 High-level requirements in the acceptance criteria fan out into many low-level ones.

hide a large amount of complexity under the hood. In some cases, the automated acceptance test may be sufficient to illustrate and verify this functionality; in other cases, each step in the high-level acceptance criteria may lead to a large number of low-level requirements that you'll express as BDD unit tests (see figure 10.5). This is typical of the BDD work process: as you implement the code required for an acceptance criterion, you'll often discover more low-level requirements that you'll also need to implement.

In this section we'll look at some of the techniques used when you expand high-level acceptance criteria into more detailed unit tests, discovering the classes, methods, and services you need as you go.

The best way to explore this idea is with a practical example. Let's see how this process would play out with the second of the acceptance criteria we introduced earlier in the chapter:

```
Scenario Outline:
  Given Joe Jones is a <initialStatus> Frequent Flyer member
  And he has <initialStatusPoints> status points
  When he earns <extraPoints> status points
  Then he should have a status of <finalStatus>
```

Describe how the application should behave.

```
  Examples: Status points required for each level
    | initialStatus | initialStatusPoints | extraPoints | finalStatus |
    | Bronze        | 0                   | 300         | Silver      |
    | Bronze        | 100                 | 200         | Silver      |
    | Silver        | 0                   | 700         | Gold        |
    | Gold          | 0                   | 1500        | Platinum    |
```

Illustrate the behavior with some basic examples.

Once again, the first task is to automate the steps in the acceptance criteria.

10.3.1 Use step definition code to explore low-level design

In this case, the definition for the first step might look like this:

```
@Given("^(.*) (.*) is a (.*) Frequent Flyer member$")
public void a_Frequent_Flyer_member(String firstName, String lastName, Status
     status) {
```